

Critical Thinking And Logic

Lesson 2: Techniques of Recognizing Arguments

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Lesson Objectives:

- **After the accomplishment of this lesson, you will be able to:**
 - Recognize argumentative passages.
 - Recognize non-argumentative passages.
 - Distinguish argumentative passages from non-argumentative passages.
 - Understand the concepts inferential claim and factual claim.

Remember that Argument is



Recognizing Argumentative Passages

Activity # 1: - Dear learners, what do you think are argumentative passages? What qualifies a passage to be an argument?

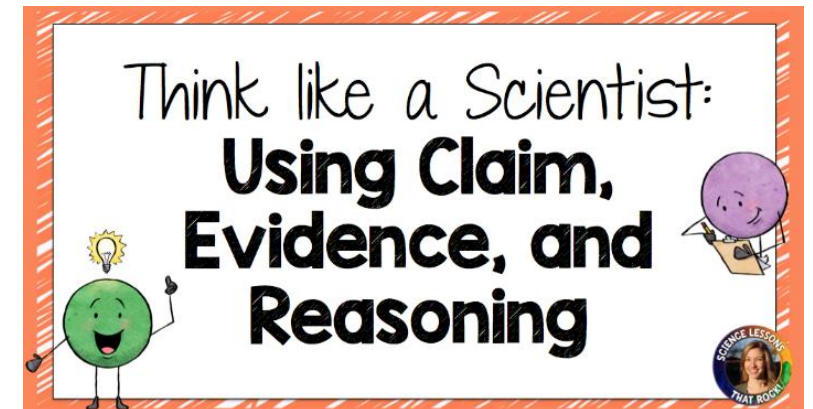


- Evaluating arguments about religion, politics, ethics, sport, science, love, culture, environment, society, is the central concern of logic.
- Since logic deals with arguments, it is important for students to develop the ability to identify whether passages contain an argument.
- In a general way, **a passage contains an argument if it support to prove something; if it does not do so, it does not contain an argument.**

But what does it mean to support to prove something?



- **Two conditions must be fulfilled for a passage to purport to prove something:**
 1. Presence of a statement that contains a claim(about result) (*inferential claim*).
 2. Presence of a statement contains prove or evidence to support that claim (*factual claim*).



Inferential claim



- An inferential claim can be either explicit or implicit.

1. *Explicit inferential claim:*

statement contains an indicator word that support a relationship between the premises and the conclusions. (mentioned before). Directly understood.

- Trick : **Explicit= Expressed easily**
- Example :
 - ✓ Jack is guilty because he murdered Karen
 - ✓ *Bill is my biological father, because my mother told so.*



Inferential claim

2. Implicit inferential claim:

The passage contains no indicator words or indirect meaning . (you have to ask questions to understand)

- Trick :

Implicit = implied

INDIRECT

- **Example:**

- ✓ The genetic modification of food is risky business. Genetic engineering can introduce unintended changes into the DNA of the food-producing organism, and these changes can be toxic to the consumer.

Exam Trick



- The presence of an **indicator** word **does not mean** that the existing indicator word actually and always indicate a premises or a conclusions.
- **Example:**
 - ***Since** Edison invented the phonograph, there have been many technological developments.*
 - ***Since** Edison invented the phonograph, he deserves credit for a major technological development.*
- In the first passage: the word “ since” is used in a temporal sense= from the time that. Thus, the first passage **is not an argument**.
- In the second passage “ since” is used in a logical sense, and so the passage is **an argument**.



Recognizing Non-argumentative Passages



Activity # 2: - Dear learners, what do you think are non-argumentative passages? What do they lack to be arguments?

- **Non-argumentative passages:**

Are passages, which lack an inferential claim. (what is missing ?is a claim).

Passages that lack an inferential claim may be statements, which could be premises, conclusion, or both but miss a claim to argue about.



You might face a denied claim because there was some sort of information missing on the claim.

Exam Trick



- Do you consider the following passages argument or not ?

1. *Whatever you promise to tell, never say secrets to your wife.*

- In this passage, no evidence is given to prove that the statement is true; and if no evidence is given to prove that the statement is true, so the passages is not an argument.

- It is called warning passage.



Exam Trick



- Do you consider the following passages argument or not ?

2. After class hours, I suggest that you give careful consideration to the subject matter you have discussed.

There is no evidence that is intended to prove anything so , is no argument.

It is called piece of advice passage.



Exam Trick



- Do you consider the following passages argument or not ?

3. *We believe that our university must develop outstanding students who will perform with great skill .*

- This passage does not make any claim that the belief or opinion is supported by evidence, or that it supports some conclusion, and hence does **not contain an argument**.
- It is called A *belief or opinion*

